

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management Specialist

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniproper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with more than five years of hands-on experience engineering, deploying, and operationally managing enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms, security operations functions, and incident response processes across large, complex environments. I have led the engineering and day-to-day management of CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, and the Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) suite - including Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) - across an estate of 8,000 or more users, working in close partnership with IT Security leadership. My technical capabilities span SIEM platform engineering, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection logic development, alert triage, threat hunting, vulnerability management, identity security, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. I bring a structured, risk-aware approach to security engineering, and I am equally at home building and refining detection capability as I am advising senior stakeholders on security posture and operational risk. I am seeking a senior cyber security engineering position within a forward-thinking organisation where SIEM and defensive operations excellence are at the centre of the security programme.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors, watchlists), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk/SPL
- **CrowdStrike Falcon Platform:** Falcon NG-SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, Falcon Discover
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender, Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps
- **Incident Response and Security Operations:** Full incident lifecycle per NIST 800-61, alert triage, forensic investigation, containment, remediation, post-incident reporting
- **Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering:** Hypothesis-driven hunting, MITRE ATT&CK framework, detection rule development, alert tuning
- **Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook design and automation, PowerShell scripting, workflow integration
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Email and Perimeter Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead the engineering, configuration, and operational management of enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms across an estate of 8,000+ users, including Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), ensuring continuous detection coverage and platform availability.

- Design and maintain KQL analytics rules, detection workbooks, data connectors, and watchlists in Microsoft Sentinel to correlate security events, surface threats, and reduce false positive volume through precision tuning.
- Manage the CrowdStrike Falcon platform - including NG-SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Falcon Prevent, Insight, and Discover - to deliver comprehensive endpoint protection, threat investigation, and real-time adversary detection across the entire estate.
- Own the deployment and operational management of the Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) suite - including Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) - covering all 8,000+ users, with direct responsibility for alert triage, incident investigation, and resolution.
- Lead incident response activities through the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle including detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned, reporting outcomes to the IT Security Officer and senior stakeholders.
- Architect and operationalise Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks to automate routine containment, notification, and remediation tasks, materially improving operational efficiency and reducing mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Conduct proactive threat hunting and SIEM-driven detection engineering using MITRE ATT&CK framework analysis to identify and close coverage gaps, contributing to continuous improvement of the organisation's detection posture.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies to enforce least-privilege principles and protect privileged accounts across the estate.
- Report on security operations performance, SIEM health, and incident trends to the IT Security Officer, translating technical findings into clear, actionable business risk language.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst

- Operated and maintained SIEM tooling across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, triaging, investigating, and resolving security alerts and events within agreed service level agreements (SLAs) to protect organisational assets and data.
- Authored KQL-based threat queries and alert-tuning recommendations in Microsoft Sentinel to improve SIEM detection fidelity, reduce analyst alert fatigue, and ensure high-quality escalations.
- Contributed to SIEM data connector management and onboarding of new log sources to broaden event coverage and improve the organisation's overall security visibility.
- Supported end-to-end incident response activities - including evidence gathering, containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting - maintaining structured evidence chains and regular stakeholder updates throughout.
- Delivered vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), identifying, prioritising, and tracking remediation of vulnerabilities across the estate by risk rating.
- Administered Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) identity and access controls including Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Single Sign-On (SSO) to maintain a strong identity security posture.
- Used PowerShell scripting to automate security administration and operational tasks, improving team efficiency and consistency of security configurations across the environment.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and maintained security controls, infrastructure hardening, and quality assurance processes within a Software as a Service (SaaS) and financial technology (FinTech) company, ensuring data protection and operational resilience in a regulated commercial environment.
- Supported security monitoring, incident triage, and IT infrastructure management across cloud and on-premises systems, contributing to the protection of business and customer data assets.
- Assisted with endpoint security configuration, device management, and network security tooling to maintain compliance and reduce the organisation's attack surface.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the full engineering deployment and operationalisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000+ users at UAL, delivering comprehensive endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR) coverage and a significant uplift in the organisation's threat detection and incident response capability.
- Engineered and maintained a library of KQL analytics rules, detection workbooks, and SIEM alert logic in Microsoft Sentinel, measurably improving detection coverage against MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques and reducing false positive alert volume.
- Designed and implemented Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that automated containment, notification, and remediation workflows, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common incident types and improving analyst capacity for complex investigations.
- Established an ongoing vulnerability management programme using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, and AppCheck, delivering regular risk-prioritised remediation plans and demonstrating measurable reduction in the organisation's exposure to known vulnerabilities over time.
- Maintained active Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification, demonstrating breadth of knowledge across all eight security domains including security architecture, operations, risk management, and identity and access management.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)